The Australian Effie Awards

General Entry Form 2015

Entry Number: 202

Agency The Works Sydney

Advertiser Beam Suntory

Entry Title Keeping Australians 'Over Beer' for 5-years

Category for this Entry Long term effects

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Directions appearing with each question must not to be deleted from the completed case; they serve as a guide for both entrants and judges. Complete entry form in - Type face: black font; 10pt minimum. All data must include a specific, verifiable source. Refer to the Effie "How to Enter" booklet for guidelines on properly sourcing your data. Data without a source will result in entry disqualification. Answer every question or indicate "not applicable" and define your target audience in the entry. Any unanswered question will result in entry disqualification.

Executive Summary (Please Attach the Executive Summary to the front of the entry so the judges can read this first)
An Executive Summary of no more than 100 words is also required (not included in page count).

Not long ago, the Australian alcohol landscape was dominated by beer. After a few cold ones, some people might switch to a Ready To Drink (RTD) combination offered by Beam-Suntory. Then a tax hike on RTDs made this less likely. The future of RTDs was bleak. Until Canadian Club and Dry stood up to be counted. Discovering that 'beer boredom' was an actual thing, and an audience of younger drinkers was gasping for a change of flavour, we set out to achieve the highly improbable. Get Aussies 'Over Beer' and stay 'Over Beer'. Four years later, the results make for very refreshing reading.

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1. Total Campaign Expenditure
What was your total expenditure including development, media, production, agency fees and any other costs? Including production and value of donated media and non-traditional paid media.

$32 million (2010 to 2014) – includes production.

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2. What was the strategic communications challenge?
What was going on in your category? Provide information on the category, marketplace, company, competitive environment, target audience and/or the product /service that created your challenge and your response to it.

The business challenge: Finding growth in a no-growth market

Originally, in mid-2009 Beam-Suntory was at a crossroads. Growth had stalled. As the business was planning to go public in 2011, this had to be corrected lest the IPO tank. Growth had to be found. (The business challenge post IPO was to maintain growth and defend the market we disrupted).

New tax blindsides the business

A year earlier, Federal taxes on RTD premixed drinks were raised almost 70% (Figure 1[1]), causing the price of Beam-Suntory's portfolio to shoot through the roof. A slab of RTDs had cost roughly the same as a slab of beer, but not anymore (Figure 2[2]). Not even close…

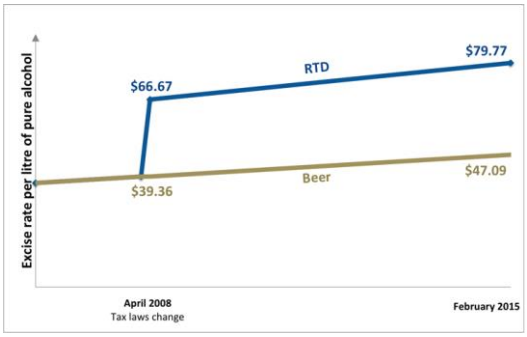


Figure 1: Excise tax rate on RTD increased in April 2008 almost 70%.

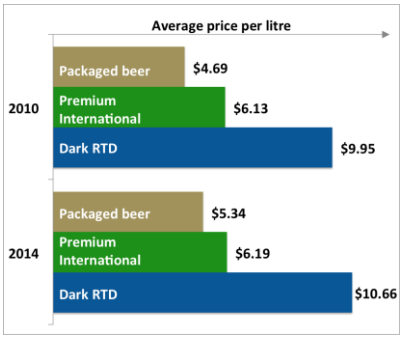


Figure 2: Tax changes in 2008 established a significant price disadvantage for Dark RTDs versus beer.

Year-on-year, Aussies were actually drinking less alcohol!

So much so that by 2013, alcohol consumption per person was at its lowest point in 17 years. Even beer, Australia's most popular drink (by volume), was in decline, steadily losing share to wine, spirits and ciders (Figure 3[3]).

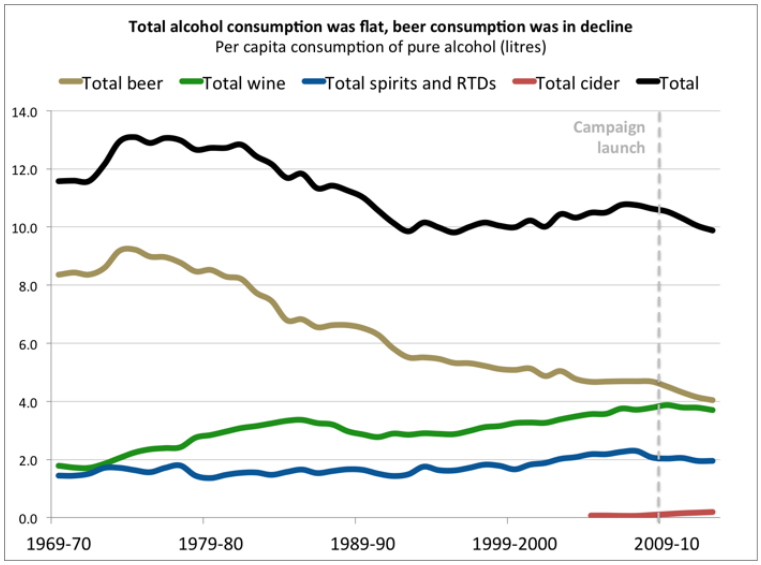


Figure 3: Alcohol consumption was flat, and declined to a 17 year low in 2013. Beer consumption trending down since the mid 1970s.

Innovate or die

Unsurprisingly the Beam-Suntory business took a massive hit. Facing what Trent Chapman (Marketing Director of Beam-Suntory) called "the mother of all strategic inflection points", it had to reengineer its entire portfolio to get back to growth.

Time to take on a behemoth?

Beam-Suntory needed people who thought RTDs weren't 'for them' to try one. This meant finding a way to steal share from beer, because that's where the greatest number of potential new drinkers lay.

We needed a steady flow of 'new recruits'

The long-term success of any alcohol brand depends on its ability to continually attract younger adults. This lifestage is characterised by experimentation and 'repertoire drinking' before they settle into a handful of personal favourites. **So our target audience was 'new recruits': 20-29 year olds with a (very) slight male skew**[4].

But we lacked a perceived good 'first drink of the night'

To steal share from beer, you need a credible alternative – a good first drink of the night. This means something refreshing, light and 'sessionable' (you'd happily carry on drinking it). Dark RTDs, while 'switchable' after a few beers, are just not perceived as 'sessionable'.

Could Canadian Club be our 'first drink'?

Canadian Club (CC) is a rye whiskey. It is lighter than bourbon, and when mixed with dry ginger, is both refreshing and sessionable. Previously a Beam-Suntory niche player – albeit one with a solid fan base – CC had all the 'good first drink of the night' credentials[5]. Could it take on the might of beer?

Our strategic communications challenge

Our challenge was to take CC, rebrand and position it to consistently grow the RTD market by stealing 'new recruits' from beer, in spite of its almost iconic status, and our significant price disadvantage.

3. What were your objectives? State specific goals.

Your entry is expected to include compelling data including behavioural objectives and results. Only in rare instances are the judges likely to award an entry that only demonstrates attitudinal changes. Provide a % or # for all goals. If you do not have a specific type of objective (e.g. no quantifiable objectives), state this in the entry form and explain why and why the objectives you do have are significant and challenging in the context of your category, etc. You must provide benchmark and context for your goals versus year prior and in context of competitive landscape and category.

To grow CC, we needed consistent flow of mainstream growth, which meant it needed to be available in more places, have more people drinking it, and have our drinkers drink it more often. Our objectives:

1. Grow distribution locations by 35% by 2014.
2. Increase the number of CC drinkers by 35%, from 463,000 drinkers (benchmarked at 2009), to over 625,050 by 2014.
3. Increase consumption (cases per drinker) by 35% from the 2009 baseline of 0.8 cases per person per year, to over 1.08 case per person per year in 2014.

	Benchmark					
	2009	**2010**	**2011**	**2012**	**2013**	**2014**
Distribution locations	**2,728**	2,897	3,076	3,266	3,468	3,683
Number of drinkers (CC RTD)	**463,000**	491,641	522,053	554,346	588,638	625,050
Cases consumed per drinker (CC RTD)	**0.80**	0.85	0.90	0.96	1.02	1.08

Table 1: Our objectives, and how they would need to progress throughout campaign.

4. What was your strategy – and how did you get there?

What was your strategy? Was it driven by a consumer insight or channel insight or marketplace / brand opportunity? Explain how it originated and how the strategy addressed the challenge.

How we got there

We hate focus groups. So instead we spent time living with new recruits. We did this via extended one-on-one ethnographies, house parties with friendship circles, and video diaries. We learned the following things which, when mashed together, led to the three-pronged strategy:

1a. New recruits have latent 'beer boredom'

New recruits are bombarded by beer brands desperately trying to be 'down with the youth'. But 'the youth' see beer as a safe and predictable choice – it's brainless, relatively cheap and what everyone else is drinking. They don't have passion or excitement for it (Figure 4). *Strategically this meant we needed to tap into 'beer boredom'.*

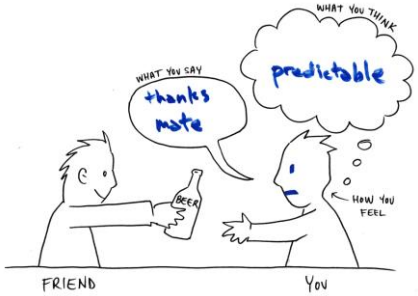


Figure 4: Projective exercises and a 'rate your mate' drinking game uncovered latent 'beer boredom'

1b. A simple 'nudge' taps into beer boredom

Using a behavioural economics technique called 'priming'[6] – where you change people's behaviour via simple questions – we found that asking, "Are you bored with beer?" coupled with providing a credible alternative, opened them up to trying CC. *Strategically this meant we had to ask priming questions to drive trial.*

2. To steal from beer we had to be 'refreshing'

Like most Australians, new recruits want their first drink to be easy to drink and refreshing[7]. *Strategically this meant everything about CC had to be 'refreshing' – from the product and packaging, to the point of sale and look-and-feel of the advertising.*

3. We had to be on the 'path-to-pub'

Importantly, we uncovered that new recruits usually have *no idea* what they're going to buy at the bottleshop when they leave the house or office. They might know they feel like beer or wine or spirits, but they have rarely settled on a specific brand in advance. Instead, they make up their minds on the way, or in the bottleshop itself. Young adults make their purchase decisions in store during the 'last three feet'[8]. *Strategically this meant we needed to ensure we: 1) were distinctively disruptive in store; and 2) hit new recruits with ads on the 'path-to-pub'.*

We needed to keep it simple and consistent

As a guiding principle, we adopted a marketing philosophy from Professor Byron Sharp (marketing scientist). Sharp believes a marketer's focus should be on simple and consistent brand assets that are easy to remember and when seen, trigger instinctual responses. Consistent and constantly used, easy-to-remember brand assets will, over time, create distinctive memory structures – that bring the brand front-of-mind at the right time in the right place, when a consumer is shopping our category (a.k.a. mental availability)[9].

5. What was your big idea?

What was the idea that drove your effort?

The idea should not be your execution or tagline. ***State in 25 WORDS OR LESS.***

"Beer gets boring".

Get new recruits to try CC by pointing out how always starting with a beer gets stale.

6. How did you bring the idea to life?

Describe and provide rationale for your communications ***strategy*** *that brings the idea to life. Explain how your idea addresses your challenge. Describe the channels selected/why selected? How did your* ***creative and media strategies*** *work together? In not more than three A4 pages show sufficient creative examples to enable the judges to understand the campaign. These pages can be additional to the eight A4 page written entry.*

We made the product and packaging key visual 'refreshing'



Figure 5: The CC Snowy Vista, our codified key visual, consistently used in multiple channels from 2010 - 2014.

To ensure we were distinctive in the bottleshop, we revamped the packaging and branding to make sure everything communicated 'refreshing'. The new branding was designed to pass the 'blink test' – that disengaged consumers instantly understood that CC was 'refreshing' and 'like a premium beer'.

The CC Snowy Vista (Figure 5), our codified key visual, is a bottle sticking out of the pristine white snow that says "cold" and "clean", both of which are key for being refreshing. The clear blue sky is wide open and hints towards summer (when most beer gets consumed). The shape of the bottle and the lime says "this is like a refreshing premium beer".

We tested then executed a 'path-to-pub' media strategy



Figure 6: Creative 'Path-to-pub' media strategy targeted pubs and large bottleshops to ensure people on their way to purchase were primed with 'Over Beer?'.

We didn't have the cash to carpet-bomb Australia with our message. So instead, we leveraged a key research learning – that new recruits decide what they're going to buy at the last minute – and developed a creative and disruptive 'path-to-pub' media strategy to test in NSW only.

By selectively placing advertising outside bottleshops across the state in 2010, potential alcohol buyers were primed with 'Over Beer?', and many of those who answered "yes" picked up a slab of CC instead.

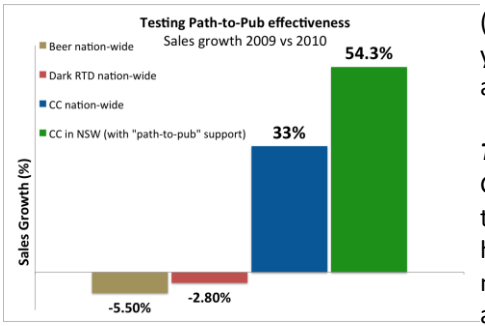


Figure 7: Sales in NSW outperformed the nation, proving the effectiveness of the 'path to pub' media strategy and the 'Over Beer?' message.

We proved it worked (and won an Effie in the process – 2011) (Figure 7[10]). Then we rolled it out nationally. In subsequent years we bolstered our advertising with mass-reach outdoor and TV, critical for becoming a mass-market brand[11].

The activities that followed

Grounded by Byron Sharp's marketing philosophy, we used the same strategy executed over time from 2010 to 2014 – honing in on what worked as it became apparent, and doing more of it – i.e. sticking to consistent brand messaging; testing and learning; and maintaining focus and discipline.

Tactical execution: The launch – Beer beer beer (Feb. 2010 to 2011)

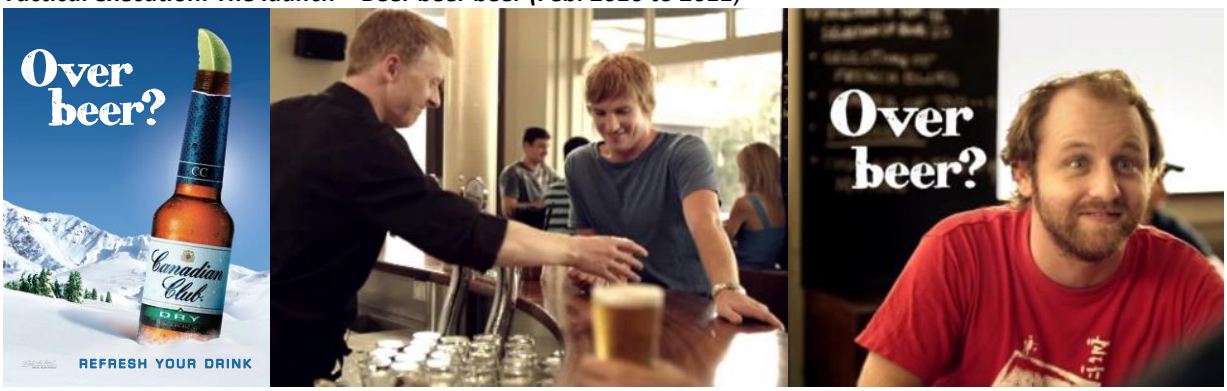


Figure 8.1: 'Over Beer?' outdoor which appeared on the 'Path to pub'
Figure 8.2: 'Sleep drinking' behaviour dramatized in the 'No thankyou' TVC 2010.
Figure 8.3: the 'Over Beer?' nudge in 'Recommend' 2010 TVC 2010

Goal: Wake Aussies out of their sleep-drinking habits and make CC the refreshing alternative to beer boredom.
Audience: 20-29 year-old 'new recruits'. Ads played during "Entourage" on Foxtel to reach them nationwide.[12]
Key message: 'Over Beer?'. If they answered "No" we would be unlikely to ever recruit them. But if they answered "Yes", then it would put us on their radar, and they would know what CC is an alternative for.
Impact: Sales increased 33% nationally – signalling to trade that Beam-Suntory's investment gets punters into stores. As a result, we got core ranging with the big 4 bottleshop owners[13], giving us the availability to go bigger.

Tactical execution: Boonie (July 2011 – 2012)



Figure 9.1: Boonie caught cheating on beer in 2011 Off-premise Point of sale.
Figure 9.2: Screenshot from our "sprung" branded TVC in 2011.
Figure 9.3: Full page print ad in FMH magazine 2011.

Learning: Australians were receptive to our 'Over Beer?' question and so we needed to give it some exposure.
Goal: Prove to Aussie drinkers that CC was an acceptable alternative to beer.
Audience: Mainstream beer drinkers.
Key message: Even Ex-VB ex-spokesman David 'Boonie' Boon could make the switch to CC.
Impact: Convince thousands of Aussie beer drinkers that a whiskey RTD was a socially acceptable alternative to beer. In fact, CC sold more than 100,000 cases in December 2011, the largest sales month to date[14].

Tactical execution: Beer Fairies (May 2012 – 2013)





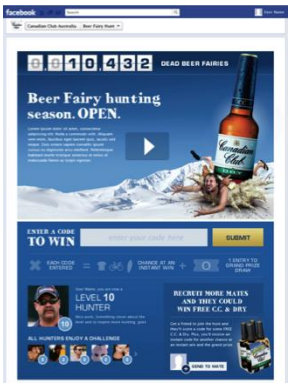


Figure 10.1: 2012 Off-premise Point of sale poster encouraging the extermination of Beer fairies.
Figure 10.2: Screenshot from our 2012 'Brewery' TVC.
Figure 10.3: Beer fairies 2012 Facebook app, where drinkers brought beer fairies into the real world.

Learning: CC needed to start acting more like a big beer brand with engaging personality, not a niche RTD.
Goal: Polarise beer drinkers to engage with the brand and try CC.
Audience: Mainstream beer drinkers
Key message: Help mainstream beer drinkers distance themselves from beer's ugly truth – Beer Fairies.
Impact: Encouraged more than 94,000 members of the beer-drinking public to stand against Beer Fairies in the real world, as they entered into our 'hunting season' competition[15]. We had a 68,000 case increase in sales as a direct result of CC TVCs in 2013[16], and as a result, CC TM broke the 1 million case MAT landmark in Oct. 2012.[17]

Tactical execution: Taste (Dec 2013 to 2014)







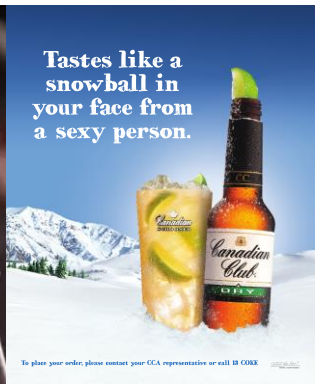


Figure 11.1: 'Tastes like…' outdoor ad from summer 2013.
Figures 11.2 & 11.3: Contextual shot of our female protagonist shot from the 'Bar' version of the 2014 Snowball in the face TVC.
Figure 11.4: 'Tastes like…'print ad in trade magazine from 2014.

Learning: 'Beer Fairies', while it worked well and caused maximum disruption, deviated slightly from our initial strategy. This, coupled with the rise of cider and craft beer in the 'traditional' beer space, had us go back to basics.
Goal: Focus on taste and refreshment to get Aussie beer drinkers to choose CC over other alternatives.
Audience: 20-29 new recruits, with a skew towards women.
Key message: Taste and refreshment from CC that you don't get from a beer.

Impact: Continued to hit our target audience on the 'Path-to-pub', where we talked about the extraordinary taste and refreshment of CC. Aussies were now drinking more CC than ever before[18] and we were consistently selling more than 100,000 cases of CC premixed each month.[19]

7. How do you know your campaign was successful?

Detail why you consider your effort a success. ***Refer to your objectives*** *(results must relate directly to your objectives in (3) – restate them and provide results) and demonstrate how you met or exceeded those objectives using quantitative and behavioural metrics. Did your effort drive in-market results? Did it drive awareness and consumer behaviour change? Use charts and data whenever possible. Explain what x% means in your category. For confidential information proof of performance may be indexed if desired. Demonstrate the correlation between activity and outcomes. Make sure you address every objective, whether fully achieved or not. Indicate why the results you have are significant in the context of your category, competition and product / service.*

		2009 benchmark	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014
Distribution locations	*Objective*		*2,897*	*3,076*	*3,266*	*3,468*	*3,683*
	Actual	**2,728**	**2,959**	**3,130**	**3,571**	**6,081**	**4,710**
Number of drinkers (CC RTD)	*Objective*		*491,641*	*522,053*	*554,346*	*588,638*	*625,050*
	Actual	**463,000**	**496,000**	**541,000**	**568,000**	**612,000**	**673,000**
Cases consumed per drinker (CC RTD)	*Objective*		*0.85*	*0.90*	*0.96*	*1.02*	*1.08*
	Actual	**0.8**	**1.1**	**1.4**	**1.7**	**2**	**2.3**

Table 2: Objectives versus actuals for the 'Over Beer?' campaign (we exceeded all of our objectives!)

Objective 1: Grow distribution locations by 35% by 2014. Measured through the number of Coles and Woolworths owned stores that stocked CC, and growth from the 2009 benchmark of 2728 stores.

- Achieved core ranging with Liquor marketing group (LMG) and independent brands Australia (IBA) in late 2010 and with Coles and Woolworths in Feb 2011. [20]
- The number of Woolworths and Coles premises increased by **73%**, more than double our 35% target, from 2,728 in 2009 to 4,710 in 2014[21].

Executing our strategy effectively grew distribution:

- Launch execution 'Over beer?' helped CC become the fastest-growing Australian alcohol trademark in October 2010[22] *despite* not having core ranging in any of the big four bottleshop owners at the time. But, as a result of this industry announcement, core ranging was achieved in the following four months.
- Distribution locations increased by 14% as a result of the Boonie campaign.[23]
- Specific content was made for trade, both in the form of PR, and advertisements in trade channels. Video content was made for CCA and the distribution team. These videos were made as part of the 'Boonie' and 'Beer Fairies' campaigns, and were used to excite trade about CC.

It is important to note at this point that increases in **sales were not simply down to increases in distribution locations**, but we will explore that later…

Objective 2: Increase CC RTD drinkers by 35% from 463,000 drinkers (2009 benchmark), to over **625,050** by 2014.

- Achieved **over 45% growth** in the number of drinkers. This meant there were 673,000 Canadian Club RTD drinkers by December 2014[24].
- **Growth came from new recruits**, our target audience. The number of 18-24 year olds drinking CC RTD almost doubled, growing by 98.6% from 2010 to 2015[25].

Executing our strategy effectively increased the number of CC drinkers:

- 'Path-to-pub'. In 2010, NSW received the same packaging, point of sale and TV support as every other state for the launch, with similar distribution pushes as well. The only difference was that NSW got the 'Path-to-pub' advertising, priming our new recruits for trial (Figure 7). Sales grew 33% nationally, but by 54% in NSW[26]. Our 'Path-to-pub' strategy was getting more drinkers to pick up a case. In subsequent years of the campaign, the strategic win of 'Path-to-pub' was rolled out nationally, and yielded continued results.

Objective 3: Get drinkers to drink CC more often. Increase volume per drinker by 35% from the 2009 baseline of 0.8 cases per person per year, to 1.08 cases per person per year in 2014.

- CC RTD drinkers were consuming 2.3 cases per person per year by 2014[27]. That's **more than double** our target, and growth of 288%!
- Consumption per person grew, on average, three times the number of drinkers[28].
- To demonstrate the vast increase in the volume of CC RTD that was consumed, our case sales went from 386,000 in 2009, to 1,520,000 in 2014. That's a compound annual growth rate of 31.5%.[29]

Executing our strategy effectively grew consumption per drinker:

- We grew our volumes significantly, when the main players in the Dark RTD market were in decline[30].
- In Dec. 2014, almost half (47.1%) of CC RTDs drinkers consumed no other type of Dark RTD, so we weren't just stealing share from our competitors[31].

Beyond exceeding all of our objectives, we know that rebranding CC to make it 'refreshing', combined with long-term execution of our strategy that included use of the 'Over Beer?' message and Snow Vista imaging, was successful for the following reasons:

- In October 2010, Nielsen announced CC was officially the fastest-growing alcohol trademark in Australia – selling faster than any other beer, wine, cider or spirit[32].
- In our launch year of 2010, sales grew 33%, with our target being just over 6.2%[33].
    - We smashed the average growth rate of our official category – Dark RTDs (premixed bourbons, rums and whiskies), which *shrank* by 2.8%. We also beat the average growth rate for beer, which *shrank* by 5.5%[34].
    - All before achieved any core ranging.
    - But critically, in terms of advertising effectiveness: In NSW (the only state with path-to-pub advertising in 2010) sales jumped an **additional** 21%, growing by a total of 54% (Figure 7).
- In 2011, CC was "the fastest-growing liquor trademark in Australia[35]."
- 2011, CC won a Silver Effie for 'Over beer?'.
- Canadian Club was in the top 4 growing spirit (including RTD) TMs by volume from 2010-2014: 4th in 2010, 2nd in 2011, 2nd in 2012, 1st in 2013 and 1st in 2014[36].
- In Dec 2014, CC TM broke the 200k cases p/month milestone, the highest sales month on record[37].

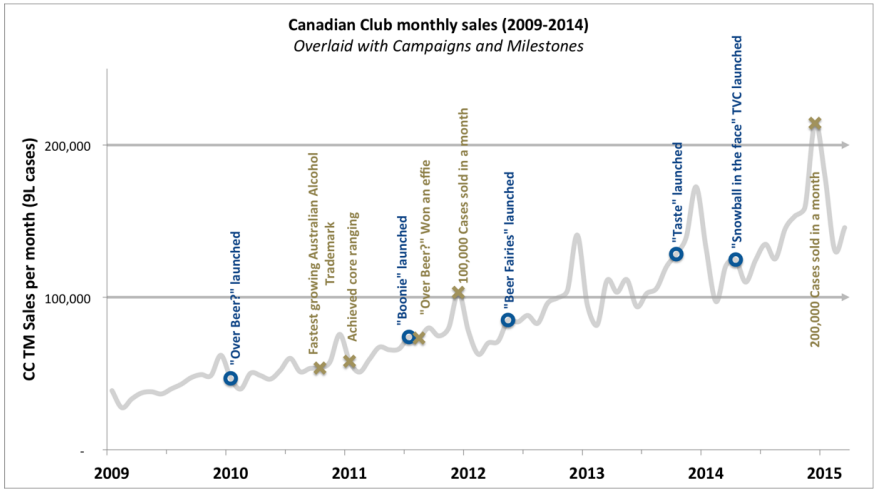


Figure 12: Overview of the campaigns, notable milestones, and month-by-month TM sales of CC.

"What the team at Beam Global Australia and The Works have achieved with Canadian Club is remarkable. They have cracked the code for using Canadian Club to bring new drinkers into our business. It will be the model for marketing this brand around the globe."

- James Sykes, VP Marketing APSA, May 2015

8. Did it achieve a positive ROI?

You need to convince the judges that the marketing investment provided a positive financial return – if that was a *requirement. Indexing of data is acceptable. Your entry will not be ineligible if you don't provide any data, but entries that do provide convincing evidence will gain additional marks. (Note that this data can be excluded from the published case on request.) We recognise that, in some instances, a measurable financial return will not be an objective, but you will need to persuade the judges why not. ROI measures by what percentage the incremental gross profit (not gross sales) generated exceeded the campaign costs/investment. 'Incremental' means comparing what happened, with what would be expected to happen had the campaign not taken place and/or that status quo maintained. So, if the incremental gross profit is $1,000 and campaign costs are $1,000, they cancel each other out and the ROI is 0%. If additional gross profit was $1,500 the ROI is 50%. (refer to the supplementary notes on ROI calculation)*

Graph and text removed

9. Convince us that the result was not due to other factors.

You must explain in your entry the effect of any other potentially relevant factors such as product changes, pricing changes, distribution changes, competitive activity, press coverage, economic conditions, weather etc. You should acknowledge and estimate the role played by other factors and you should advise if the communications program led to other benefits accruing (such as retailers taking on more SKU's, improving space allocated and access to promotional activity, or even improved support from a sales force that has 'increased belief' in the brand). Advertising rarely works in isolation but the judges need to be convinced that your campaign had a major impact on results.

There was no heavy discounting.

To help get Beam-Suntory out of the weeds, CC needed to succeed at full price – price per litre was consistent with its key competitors (Figure 14[38]); therefore removing price-discounting as a major contributor to growth. CC and the RTD category in general lost price parity with beer. We were recruiting beer drinkers, despite being twice the average price of beer (Figure 2[39]).

In 2010 there was no discounting, yet we saw a 41% volume increase in C.C. RTD during 2010[40]. In the years that followed, *"Price promotion was in line with competitors"* – Trent Chapman.

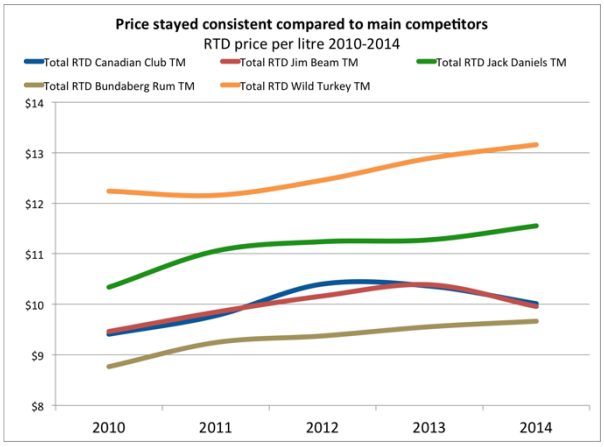


Figure 14: Prices have risen across our main competitors, with CC remaining near the middle of the pack.

There was no catalogue support

There was no catalogue support in 2010 as we weren't (yet) part of anyone's core range. The big bottleshops only put products in catalogues that can be found in all their stores. Despite a lack of catalogue support, CC outperformed all of its objectives in 2010, and grew its volume by 33%[41].

What about the new packaging and distribution?

As we've mentioned, 'Over Beer?' launched in tandem with new packaging. Indeed, they were designed to work together. And distribution was significantly increased, too. There goes the entry, right? Well, no. And here's why…



Our successfully revamped brand secured new distribution

To grow distribution, you need a compelling story that convinces these large players to buy more of you, and put you in more of their stores. The reinvention of CC gave them the reasons for getting behind CC – new packaging, point of sale, brand strategy, sales strategy, and margin opportunity – that had previously been missing. Brand Director Trent Chapman: "If we hadn't revamped CC and been able to clearly communicate our strategy for taking the brand forward, there is no way we'd have been able to grow distribution."

New look, new attitude, same refreshing liquid

No changes were made to the bottle, liquid, label, during the campaign period. Different quantities could be purchased, e.g. 10 packs, limited edition 24 packs. Different CC RTD products became available during the campaign period, including CC Summer Crisp and CC Classic. These helped expand the relevant consumption occasions for our drinkers, and allowed us to tackle beer on multiple fronts, but the core proposition of a

refreshing liquid, never changed. Creative stayed the same throughout, along with the ever-present question of 'Over Beer?'. We couldn't have increased distribution without first fixing the brand. New packaging and 'Over Beer?' were critical for convincing the trade to get behind CC in the first place. In this way they were key drivers of distribution, itself a key driver of sales growth.

We didn't grow volume on distribution alone

Between 2010 and 2014, the number of CCs premises grew 59%. During the same period, the volume per outlet grew 72%. So while we were available in more places, we were also selling more per store[42]. The increase in sales was not solely due to wider availability (Figure 15).

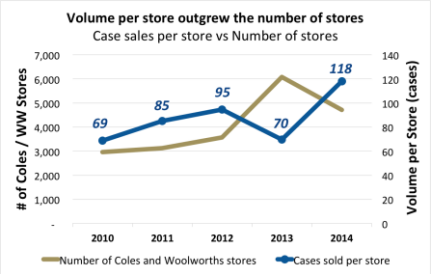


Figure 15: Volume of CC per store outgrew char in distribution locations. Increased sales were down to increased distribution alone.

But weren't Australian's drinking more anyway?

Alcohol consumption per person in Australia was flat or in decline[43]. Despite this, CC RTD consumption per person almost tripled during the campaign period[44]. Even with a changing Australian drink-scape, including the rise of cider and craft beers throughout the campaign period, we still managed to grow CC RTD with a massive lift in case sales of 294%![45].

CC drinkers grew in a declining Dark RTD market

The Dark RTD category was shrinking because of price disadvantage due to new increased tax on RTDs. Even with the tax price rise, our campaigns still managed to drive CC RTD sales and exceed all of our objectives. What's more, the number of drinkers in the Dark RTD category had declined by 16% since March 2010, with the volume consumption only increasing by 3% (Figure 15[46]). Despite this, CC RTD drinkers grew by 86% in a declining market, Proving that we weren't riding the growth of the category - we were the exception in the category!

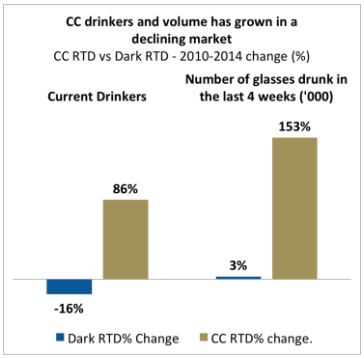


Figure 16: Canadian Clubs drinkers and volume defied the categories overall decline.

We didn't outspend our competitors – just outperformed them all

Marketing spend vs. our key RTD competitors was not disproportionately large. While we spent less or around the same as our competitors[47], we consistently outperformed our biggest competitors, year on year throughout the campaign (Table 3[48]).

	Average yearly media spend 2010-2014 ($000)	Average YoY volume growth rate 2010-2014 (%)
Canadian club TM	1,338	13.7
Wild Turkey TM	1,618	9.6
Jack Daniels TM	1,099	0.6
Bundaberg TM	3,338	-1.9
Jim Beam TM	1,422	-14.7

Table 3: Our spend was modest compared to some of our competitors, yet we outgrew them by a substantial amount Year on Year.

But the final proof of effectiveness is found in NSW…

NSW got the same packaging, point-of-sale and TV support as every other state. It got a similar distribution push to every other state, too. But only NSW got the 'Path-to-pub' advertising in 2010. It was the control group that allowed us to see what happened in NSW, compare it to what happened in the rest of the country, and thereby isolate the impact of the extra advertising. While sales grew 33% nationally, in NSW sales grew 54% (Figure 7). Almost two-thirds higher, and the only difference was the 'Path-to-pub' advertising. This is why we know it worked.

10. Do you think there are any lessons to be learned from this case about advertising effectiveness or measurement?

Judges will give additional marks to exceptional ideas, exceptional results and to cases that teach us something about how advertising works. A big idea

is worth more than a lesser idea. A case that adds to our knowledge about advertising effectiveness or measurement deserves additional marks. These marks are open to the discretion of the judges. This is the "I wish I'd been responsible for that" factor. Reward great ideas, great results, originality, innovative measurement techniques. Penalise poorly written cases. High scores here will be the cases we want marketing students to be inspired by; the cases we can learn something from; the cases we want to showcase to the world.

The most exciting lesson to be learned from this David and Goliath tale is that the little guy, with perfect planning, precise execution and bravery to not only stand up to, but also kick the giant's butt. If you get your one and only shot right – at the right time, in the right place and at the right velocity – and are prepared to back yourself to the hilt, even a cow as sacred as the amber nectar is to your average thirsty Aussie can be taken down.

Seven supporting virtues:

1. Simple, consistent and constantly used brand assets that are easy to remember and when seen, trigger instinctual responses. The impact over time creates distinctive memory structures that bring the brand front-of-mind when a consumer is shopping that category (a.k.a. ***mental availability***).
2. Distinctive brand and messaging that will pass the ***'blink test'*** to deliver a brand impression (e.g., 0.5 secs = that's CC) can instantly communicate CC's core promise: Refreshing + like a beer.
3. Communicating the real brand meaning rather than just the look it embodies. Brand needs to be central to the emotional connection we make with our audience, but needs to ***go beyond logo and colour schemes***.
4. The power of ***behavioural economics 'priming'*** (asking simple questions) can work to engage the audience.
5. ***Test and learn*** – find the creative that punches the hardest and focus on that. While 'Beer fairies' continued to disrupt the beer drinker, however didn't stay true to core message 'Over beer?'.
6. Trial purchase doesn't guarantee repeat consumption. ***Consistent and constant messaging*** can acts as a reminder of the brand & products' promise, driving the decision making process to be less laborious and more automated[49].
7. ***Stick to your knitting*** – i.e., It's okay, even desirable to associate with things that our audience finds cool or hip – but we need to remember it's an emotional connection that we're aiming for – but don't overdo it or else you wind up looking like a middle-age dad trying to impress his teenage daughters.

References

[1] Australian Tax Office 2008.
[2] Source: Nielsen ScanTrak Liquor, December 2010 & IRI-Aztec MarketEdge Liquor January 2015.
[3] Australian Bureau of Statistics, long term trends in the apparent consumption of Alcohol in Australia 2013.
[4] Men start with beer more often than women. However, it was only a *slight skew* because we were happy to poach women from other drinks. So we didn't want the branding or marketing to be overly 'blokey' and thereby alienate women.
[5] Charlie Cochrane qualitative research, October 2009.
[6] From Nudge theory: the manner in which people are 'primed' or softened/hardened before a situation or option is *from Nudge: Improving decisions about health, wealth and happiness*, Thaler and Sunstein, (Penguin, 2008) pages 75 and 76.
[7] Charlie Cochrane qualitative research, October 2009.
[8] *"The effect of Point of Sale Promotions on the alcohol purchasing behaviour of young people in metropolitan, regional and rural Australia".* Jones, S. C. & Smith, K. M. (Journal of Youth Studies, 14 (8), 885-900 2011)
[9] "H*ow brands grow: what marketers don't know"* Byron Sharp (Oxford University Press, 2010)
[10] Liqour Merchants Association 2010 Full market read by volume by state.
[11] "H*ow brands grow: what marketers don't know"* Byron Sharp (Oxford University Press, 2010)
[12] Razor Media (BGA's media partner at the time) recommended *Entourage* in October 2009, as it is popular with 20-29 year olds.
[13] Core ranging was achieved with LMG and IBA in late 2010, and with Coles and Woolworths in Feb 2011, by our distributor Coca-Cola Amatil.
[14] Aztec Australian Liquor scan 2011.
[15] Competition entries recorded by Beam-Suntory 2012.
[16] Beam Suntory Marketing mix Analysis 2014.
[17] Aztec Australian Liqour Scan 2012, October 2012 moving annual total (MAT) of 1,000,230 Cases.
[18] Aztec Australian Liquor Scan 2014 and Roy Morgan 18+ Quarter weights 2014.
[19] Aztec Australian Liquor Scan 2014: combined CC RTD case sales were over 100,000 each month of 2014, apart from February 2014.
[20] Core ranging was achieved with LMG and IBA in late 2010, and with Coles and Woolworths in Feb 2011, by our distributor, Coca-Cola Amatil.
[21] Woolworths Group Liquor Scan and Coles combined scan 2014.
[22] Fastest growing Alcohol trademark - Nielsen ScanTrack Liquor, Top 50 brands, MAT October 2010. "Trademark" is the aggregate of all products within a brand. It is a way for Nielsen to calculate the sales and value of umbrella brands like Carlton and Tooheys which have

multiple products with their brand name on them. Within the CC "trademark" there are two products: The RTD and the full-spirit bottle. Sales of full-spirit are almost flat, meaning the growth of the trademark is driven by RTD sales.

[23] Woolworths Group Liquor Scan and Coles combined scan 2010 vs 2011.
[24] Roy Morgan 18+ Quarter weights January 2009 – December 2014.
[25] Roy morgan 18+ 18-24 year olds Quarter weights March 2010 – December 2014.
[26] Liqour Merchants Association 2010 Full market read by volume by state.
[27] Aztec Australian Liquor Scan 2009 - 2014 and Roy Morgan 18+ Quarter weights 2009 -2014.
[28] Aztec Australian Liquor Scan 2009 - 2014 and Roy Morgan 18+ Quarter weights 2009 -2014.
[29] Aztec Australian Liquor Scan 2009 – 2014.
[30] Aztec Australian Liquor Scan 2009 – 2014.
[31] Roy Morgan Share of throat 2015.
[32] Fastest growing Alcohol trademark - Nielsen ScanTrack Liquor, Top 50 brands, MAT October 2010. "Trademark" is the aggregate of all products within a brand. It is a way for Nielsen to calculate the sales and value of umbrella brands like Carlton and Tooheys which have multiple products with their brand name on them. Within the CC "trademark" there are two products: The RTD and the full-spirit bottle. Sales of full-spirit are almost flat, meaning the growth of the trademark is driven by RTD sales.
[33] Aztec Australian Liquor Scan 2009 vs 2010.
[34] Liquor Merchants Association, 2010 full market read by volume.
[35] Aztec Australian Liquor Scan 2011.
[36] Aztec Australian Liquor Scan 2011.
[37] Aztec Australian Liquor Scan 2011.
[38] Aztec Australian Liquor Scan 2010-2014.
[39] Aztec Australian Liquor Scan 2010-2014.
[40] Aztec Australian Liquor Scan 2010-2011.
[41] Aztec Australian Liquor Scan 2010-2014.
[42] Coles and Woolworths indicative of Larger bottle shop growth - Woolworths Group Liquor Scan and Coles combined scan 2010 - 2014.
[43] Australian Bureau of Statistics, long term trends in the apparent consumption of Alcohol in Australia 2013.
[44] Aztec Australian Liquor Scan 2009 - 2014 and Roy Morgan 18+ Quarter weights 2009 -2014.
[45] Aztec Australian Liquor Scan 2009 – 2014.
[46] Roy Morgan 18+ Quarter weights 2009 -2014.
[47] Adquest Fusion National All Media Summary 2010-2014 & Aztec Aistralia Liquor Scan 2010-2014 – Note: Adquest Fusion is the accepted industry tool in the Australian market, but ad-spend data has limitations. This should not be confused with ROI numbers.
[48] Aztec Australian Liquor Scan 2009 – 2014.
[49] *'Thinking fast and slow'* - Daniel Kahneman.